

Feathers

Modern birds are the best known feathery animals. However, experts have found fossilized feathers, which proves that dinosaurs were feathered too. Dinosaurs developed feathers on their bodies for warmth, protection, and for display, a long time before they were used for flight.

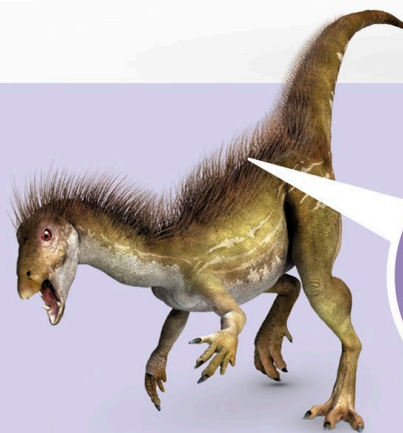
Velociraptor

In 2007, paleontologists reexamined a Velociraptor fossil and discovered little bumps on its arm bones. The feathers of birds today sprout from similar bumps, called quill knobs, suggesting Velociraptor had long feathers on its arms.



Feather types

The first dinosaur feathers were simple structures like strands of hair. They provided warmth, attracted mates, and might have worked as camouflage, helping the dinosaur to hide. Over time, feathers developed into more complicated forms until they were ready for flight.



Hollow hairlike feather shape

Bristles

From scaly skin, dinosaurs like Heterodontosaurus grew basic hairlike feathers with a bristly texture. They were hollow, with nothing inside them.